THE INTERVIEW

Working Title

INT. INTERVIEW ROOM - TIME UNDEFINED

We open on a CLOSE-UP of JESSE (mid/late 20's) against a white background.

CHRISTINA (O.C.)
Please, come forward.

Jesse smiles and steps forward, she is wearing a grey tailleur.

Jesse approaches a long white table, at the opposite end of which sits CHRISTINA (mid/late 20's). Christina is wearing a shirt with a floral pattern.

As Jesse gets to the table, Christina stands up and extends her hand.

The table is too long, so Jesse has to awkwardly walk around to reach her. They shake hands.

CHRISTINA
Welcome, I'm Christina. I will be conducting your final interview. Thank you for coming on such short notice.

JESSE
Of course. I'm Jesse, nice to meet you.

CHRISTINA
Please take a seat.

Jesse takes a sit in front of Christina. She notices she has several sheets of paper in front of her.

Christina picks one up.

CHRISTINA
I see on your file that you are originally from Slovakia.

JESSE
That is correct, but I have been a citizen of this country since-

CHRISTINA
I am aware.

JESSE
Sorry.

CHRISTINA
No need to apologise, Jesse.

Jesse nods.

CHRISTINA
Very well.
(a beat)
You moved here when you were very young to then proceed to achieve what some may refer to as extreme academic success. How would you say living abroad from such a young age has shaped your personality the most?

JESSE
Tenacity. I had to be here. I had to succeed here. I live by the belief that there is only one way forward and that way is *through.*

CHRISTINA
Through what?

JESSE
Everyone and everything.

Christina smiles. Puts down the first paper.

CHRISTINA
Let's move on to next section of the selection process: personal tendencies.

JESSE
I wasn't aware the interview would include such section.

CHRISTINA
The Company does not disclose the details of its recruitment process, Jesse.

JESSE
Of course, I'm sorry.

CHRISTINA
No need to apologise, Jesse.

Christina picks up a second sheet of paper and turns it to Jesse. It is a picture of an attractive young man.

CHRISTINA
This is your boyfriend, Jimmy.

Jesse is stunned.

CHRISTINA
Do you wish to correct that information, Jesse?

JESSE
No. No. That is my boyfriend. We've been together for-

CHRISTINA
Seven years. I understand you recently purchased a nice river-front property just outside of the city.

JESSE
We did. Yes. A couple of months ago.

CHRISTINA
What brought you to the decision of making such a commitment to your partner when you are entirely aware of the affair he has been entertaining with your quote, unquote best friend Rachel?

JESSE
I'm sorry?

CHRISTINA
No need to apologise, Jesse.

JESSE
I wasn't apologising.

CHRISTINA
Then what are you sorry about?

JESSE
There is no boyfriend's affair.

CHRISTINA
Jesse. I'm sure you do understand The Company has a strict 100% transparency policy. We cannot move forward with the interview if you insist on deliberately lying.

JESSE
I'm not lying.

Christina smiles and turns the picture of Jimmy face down.

CHRISTINA
You can leave now.

JESSE
No.

CHRISTINA
Yes, Jesse. The interview is over. Please, leave or I will have you removed.

JESSE
This is-

CHRISTINA
Please.

Jesse looks around, takes a deep breath.

JESSE
Okay. I know. I have known since the beginning, it's not like they try to hide it. You are right. But it doesn't matter. If it's in the way of working here, then it's irrelevant. It's over.

CHRISTINA
Is there anything you wouldn't do to get this job?

JESSE
No.

CHRISTINA
Would you miss your sister's funeral if you had to be at work when the time comes?

JESSE
You know about that too.

CHRISTINA
Of course we do. We know everything.

Christina stands up and loudly drags the table to the side of the room.

CHRISTINA
Please stand up.

Jesse stands up.

Christina takes her chair and places beside to the table.

Jesse looks around, then at Christina, who is impassive.

Jesse looks in the corner behind her, hesitates, then RUNS towards it.

Jesse looks back to Christina, who is emotionless.

She runs to the opposite corner as fast as she can.

Jesse turns again to Christina. Christina gives her the most imperceptible nod.

Jesse runs again.

CHRISTINA
Faster.

Jesse keeps running and keeps running. Each time with more urgency.

CAMERA PANS OUT as Jesse keeps running across the room the noise of her heels on the floor carries over into...

INT. INTERVIEW ROOM - SOME TIME LATER

Jesse, in the same floral shirt Christina was wearing, sits behind the table.

With a proud smile on her face, she stands up.

JESSE
Please, come forward.

We hear the noise of heels clicking on the floor coming towards her.

Jesse extends her hand.

JESSE
Welcome, I'm Jesse. I will be conducting your final interview. Thank you for coming on such short notice.

FADE TO BLACK.